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AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Ford | Model: Ford Laser | Australian Market Years: 1981-2002

Vehicle Type: 3-door & 5-door Hatchback / 4-door Sedan / 5-door Wagon | Segment: Small | Locally Built: Y

Assembly Plants (AU): Homebush, New South Wales (KA, KB, KC, KE, KF, KH, 1981-1994), Hofu, Japan (KJ, KL,

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The Ford Laser was one of Australia's most beloved small cars, dominating private sales and mot oring awards across the 1980s and 1990s. Born from Ford's global partnership with Mazda (sharin g the 323 platform), the Laser was manufactured at Ford's Homebush assembly plant in Sydney wit h distinct styling penned by Ford Australia's design studio. The Laser spawned the iconic 'TX3' badge?an Australian performance sensation that progressed from the twin-carb KA/KB Sport to th e ferocious KC/KE and KF/KH TX3 Turbo 4WD, packing a 1.6L/1.8L turbocharged DOHC engine, full-t ime four-wheel drive, and digital instruments. Sourcing shifted to Japan in 1994 with the impor ted KJ, KL, and KQ series before the model was succeeded by the Focus.

The Laser was the best-selling small car in Australia throughout the 1980s, repeatedly outselli ng the Toyota Corolla and Holden Gemini. The TX3 Turbo 4WD became an Australian rally weapon, d ominating Group A and Group N showroom-stock rally championships in the hands of privateers and creating a genuine cult classic today.

SERIES / GENERATION: KA-KB (KA / KB Laser) [1981-1985]

Body Styles: 3-door hatchback, 5-door hatchback | ANCAP: None

First front-wheel-drive Laser built at Homebush, Sydney. Crisp European-inspired hatchback styl ing, 1.3L and 1.5L E-series engines, and the peppy Laser Sport.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Mazda-E5S-TwinCarb: 1.5L (1490cc) Inline4 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 59.0 kW / 115.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Laser Sport: Drivetrain=FWD, Trans=5-speed manual, AUD $7890-$8990, Fuel=7.4L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* Laser Sport | 3-door hatchback | Mazda-E5S-TwinCarb | 5-speed manual | FWD | 59.0kW/115.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: KC-KE (KC / KE Laser & TX3 Turbo) [1985-1990]

Body Styles: 3-door hatchback, 5-door hatchback, 4-door sedan (Meteor), 5-door wagon | ANCAP: None

Aerodynamic styling, Homebush production. Historic launch of the TX3 Turbo and TX3 Turbo 4WD wi th 100 kW B6T engine, digital instruments, and all-wheel drive.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Mazda-B6T-Laser: 1.6L (1598cc) Inline4 (Turbocharged, Petrol) | 100.0 kW / 184.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- TX3 Turbo 4WD: Drivetrain=4WD, Trans=5-speed manual, AUD $24990-$27990, Fuel=8.5L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* TX3 Turbo 4WD | 3-door hatchback | Mazda-B6T-Laser | 5-speed manual | 4WD | 100.0kW/184.0Nm

SERIES / GENERATION: KF-KH (KF / KH Laser & TX3 Turbo 4WD) [1990-1994]

Body Styles: 3-door hatchback, 5-door hatchback, 4-door sedan | ANCAP: 2

Final Homebush Sydney-manufactured Laser. Distinctive quad round headlight front styling on TX3 , packing the upgraded 117 kW 1.8L DOHC Turbo BP-T engine and full-time 4WD.

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Engines Offered in Australia:

- Mazda-BP-T-1.8L: 1.8L (1839cc) Inline4 (Turbocharged, Petrol) | 117.0 kW / 206.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- TX3 Turbo 4WD: Drivetrain=4WD, Trans=5-speed manual, AUD $29990-$33990, Fuel=8.9L/100km

Factory Configurations:

* TX3 Turbo 4WD | 3-door hatchback | Mazda-BP-T-1.8L | 5-speed manual | 4WD | 117.0kW/206.0Nm